- An informative digital twin integrates data streams from the real world, regularly updating the digital representation.
- A predictive digital twin forecasts what the state of the physical system might be in the future, based on an understanding of the past.
- A comprehensive digital twin simulates possible future states of the physical system, using data assimilation to update mathematical models with data from the physical system.
- An autonomous digital twin closes the loop between the physical and digital realms by taking actions in the physical world based on analytics, predictions, or simulations in the digital representation.
- Before building a digital twin, you must be clear about the outcomes you are looking to achieve, what skills you will need, and whether you intend to build it from scratch, buy off the shelf capabilities, or a combination of the two.